

again (computing the mean for each set), you would find that some sample means come much closer to the population mean than others. Some would be higher than the population mean and some would be lower. Imagine sampling 10 numbers and computing the



HyperStat's layout is a little bizarre

mean over and over again, say about 1,000 times, and then constructing a relative frequency distribution of those 1,000 means. This distribution of means is a very good approximation to the sampling distribution of the mean. The sampling distribution of the mean is a theoretical distribution that is approached as the number of samples in the relative frequency distribution increases. With 1,000 samples, the relative frequency distribution is quite close; with 10,000 it is even closer. As the number of samples approaches infinity, the relative frequency distribution approaches the sampling distribution.

8.4.4 StatSoft's Electronic Textbook

<http://www.statsoft.com/textbook/stathome.html>

The Statsoft's electronic textbook has a list of topics on the right and an easily accessible search bar to help you find exactly what you want. The content ranges from beginners to intermediate, and topics are explained in a short and crisp manner, but without depth. It seems to be targeted more at Engineering Statistics than anything else.



StatSoft's Electronic Textbook is for the strong-willed only!